

Superstore Sales: The Data Story

A deep dive into \$13M of revenue — uncovering the hidden forces shaping profit, loss, and opportunity.



\$13M in Revenue, But Where's the Profit?

\$2.3M → \$4.3M

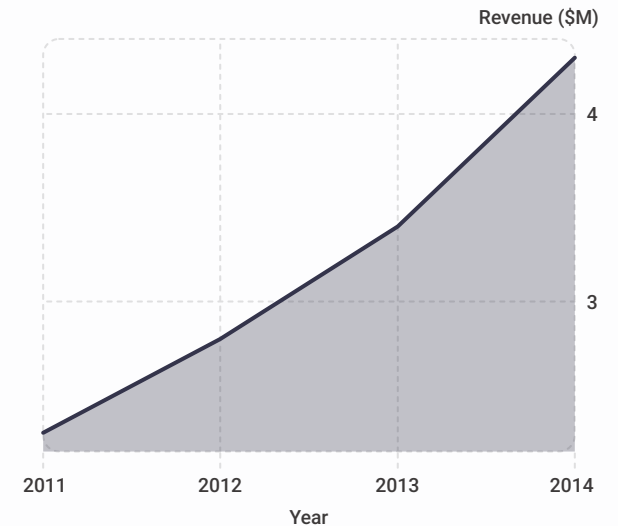
Total revenue climbed steadily from 2011 to 2014 – strong top-line growth on the surface.

11.6% Profit Margin

Despite impressive revenue, margins remain razor-thin. Hidden inefficiencies lurk beneath the numbers.

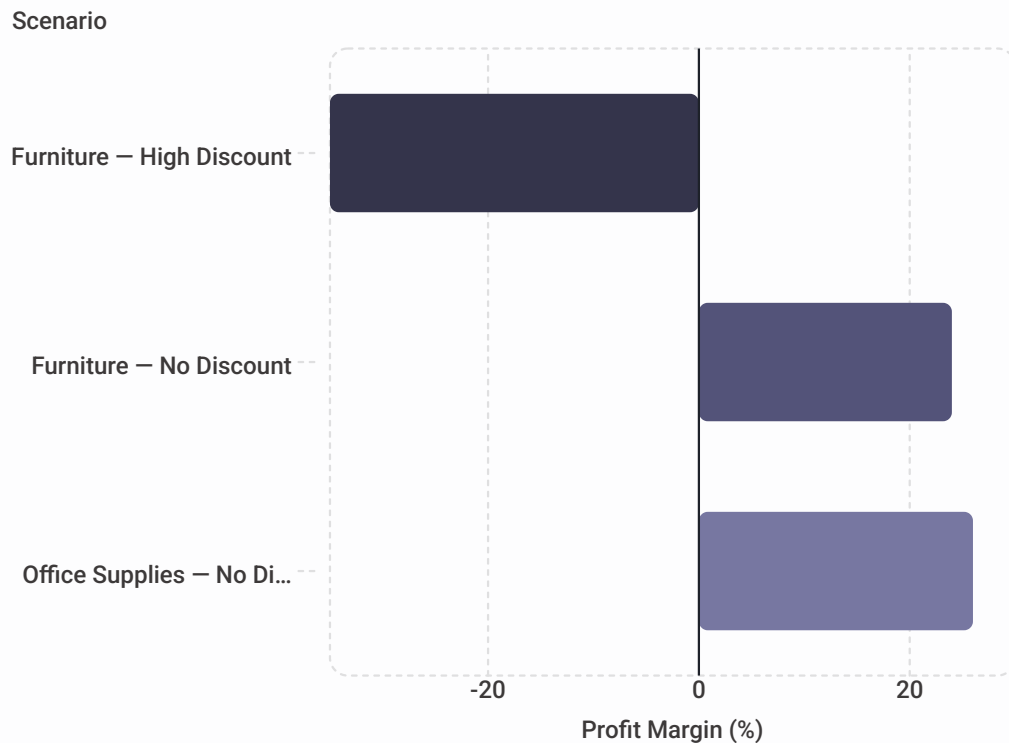
Three Categories, Three Stories

Technology, Office Supplies, and Furniture each perform dramatically differently – the aggregate masks the truth.



The Discount Trap

Aggressive discounting feels like a growth lever — the data reveals it's a profit destroyer.



High Discounts =
Losses

Furniture loses **35%** on every high-discount sale. The deeper the cut, the deeper the wound.

No Discount =
Healthy Margins

Furniture rebounds to **24%** margin — and Office Supplies hits **26%** — when discounts are removed.

Volume Doesn't Compensate

Aggressive discounting doesn't drive enough volume to offset the margin erosion. It's a losing trade.



Geography Reveals Hidden Demand



Australia Leads

\$48.6K in Technology revenue — the highest single-market performance. A proven high-value market ready for deeper investment.



US Spreads Thin

Dominates volume but dilutes margins by spreading across too many categories without focus. Scale without strategy.



Untapped Potential

Emerging markets — including Afghanistan and Angola — signal early demand patterns worth monitoring for strategic entry.

Shipping Costs: The Silent Killer

The Shipping Cost Problem

Expedited shipping inflates operational costs without delivering proportional revenue gains. Two shipping modes reveal the full picture:

⚠ Expedited shipping is being used as a default — not a premium service. This must change.



1

Same-Day Delivery

\$46.9K avg cost — rated Critical priority, yet applied far too broadly across orders that don't warrant it.

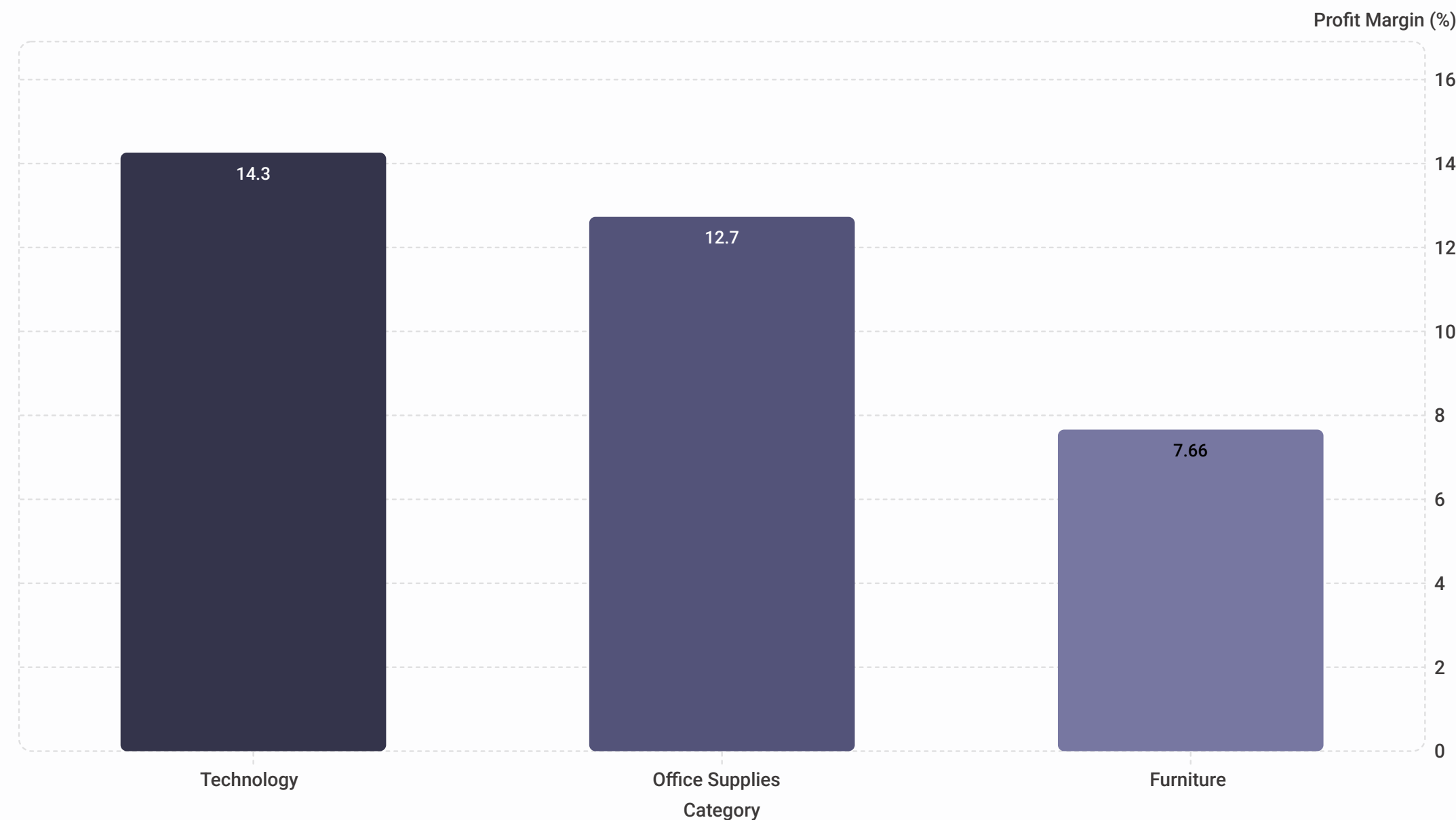
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Standard Shipping

\$50.3K avg cost — still flagged as High priority, creating a baseline cost floor that compresses margins across the board.

Category Performance: Winners & Losers

Not all categories are created equal. Margin spread across the three pillars defines where the real opportunity lies.



Technology — 14.26%

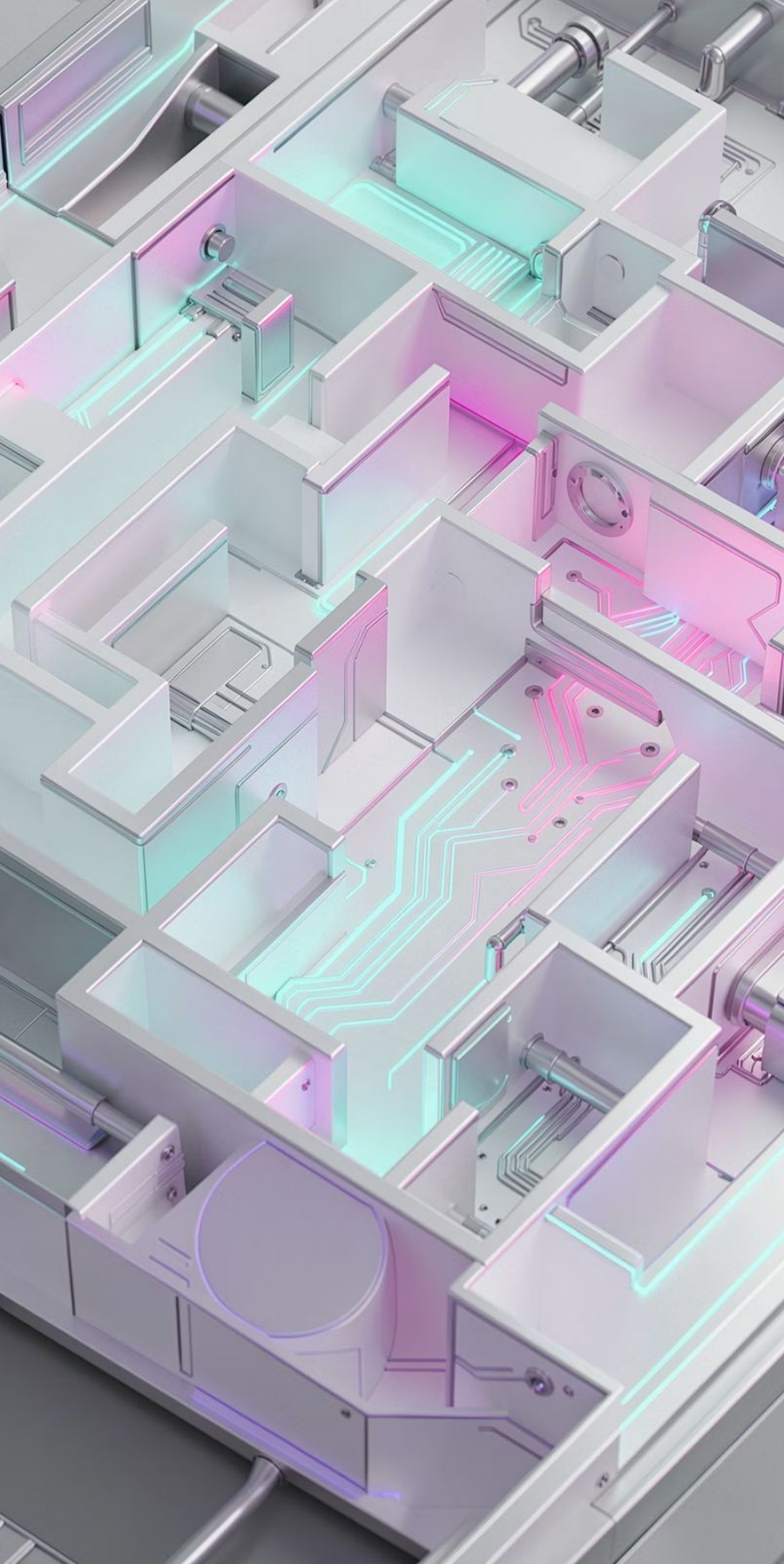
Consistent performer across regions. Highest margin, strongest geographic reach. The growth engine.

Office Supplies — 12.73%

Stable but underdifferentiated. Reliable margin floor with limited upside without repositioning.

Furniture — 7.66%

Dangerously vulnerable to discount pressure. Every markdown chips away at an already thin margin base.



The Profitability Paradox

51%

Of Sales Volume

High-discount orders represent over half of all sales — yet they generate net losses, not profit.

89%

Of Total Profit

Low-discount and no-discount tiers drive nearly all profit. The math is unambiguous.

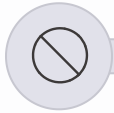
The Strategic Shift Required

The Superstore has been chasing volume — and paying for it with crushed margins. The data exposes a fundamental strategic misalignment: the orders generating the most transactions are destroying profit, while a smaller, disciplined tier carries the entire business.

The move: Premium positioning over volume chasing. Fewer discounts, higher value, stronger margins. The opportunity isn't to sell more — it's to sell smarter.

Three Moves to Unlock \$2M+ in Profit

The data has spoken. Here are the three high-impact actions to reclaim margin and accelerate profitable growth.



Eliminate High Discounts on Furniture

Shift from discount-driven promotions to **value-add bundling**. Stop trading margin for volume that doesn't pay back.



Optimize Shipping — Cap Same-Day to Critical Only

Reserve expensive same-day delivery for **genuinely critical orders**. Redirect standard shipping cost savings to bottom-line improvement.



Expand Technology — Highest Margins, Widest Reach

Double down on the category with **14.26% margin** and the strongest geographic performance. Redirect investment from Furniture drag to Technology momentum.

✅ Executing all three moves simultaneously targets \$2M+ in recoverable profit — without adding a single new customer.